

BEFORE YOU SAY A WORD

Your Audience Can't See Your **Racing Heart**

Almost every speaker feels nervous. The good news? It barely shows. The pounding heart, the butterflies, the sweaty palms, your audience rarely notices any of it. What they do notice is how you carry yourself.

Confidence on stage isn't a feeling you wait for, it's a set of small, visible habits you can practice. Turn the page for ten simple ways to look calm, grounded, and in command, no matter what's happening on the inside.

10 Tips to Look More Confident While Speaking

Small adjustments that make a big difference

Confidence on stage isn't something you're born with. It's a set of small, repeatable habits anyone can practice. **Speak Arizona** brings you courageous conversations with speakers and leaders who've learned to find their voice, and these ten tips are a great place to start.

1

Slow Your Breathing

Start here. A few deep belly breaths steady your voice and calm the jitters before you ever say a word. And if your heart still races, try this reframe a speaker once shared: imagine that pounding is your heart clapping for you, cheering you on.

2

Stand Tall and Keep Your Eyes Up

Shoulders back, chin level, gaze out toward your audience, not down at your feet. Good posture and an open gaze instantly signal authority and ease.

3

Speak Slowly

Rushing reads as nervousness. A measured pace gives your words weight and gives you room to think.

4

Mind Your Pitch

Nerves push your voice high. Settle into a steady, lower register to sound grounded and in control.

5

Dress for Success

When you look sharp, you feel sharp. The right outfit quietly boosts your own confidence too

6

Show Your Palms

Open hands signal honesty and openness. Hidden hands can read as guarded or tense.

7

Make Real Eye Contact

Connect with individuals around the room rather than fixing on one spot or the back wall.

8

Pause on Purpose

Silence after a key point feels commanding, not awkward. Let your big ideas land.

9

Plant Your Feet

Avoid pacing or swaying. A stable, balanced stance reads as steady nerves.

10

Visualize Your Success

This one is backed by science. In a Cleveland Clinic study, people who only imagined exercising a finger, with no physical movement at all, gained measurable strength over twelve weeks, because mental rehearsal fires the same brain pathways as the real thing. Before you speak, vividly picture yourself walking up calm, delivering with ease, and earning the applause. Your brain rehearses confidence so your body can deliver it.

FROM THE SPEAK ARIZONA PODCAST

"People show up at a club because they want confidence. Who provides it to them? We do."

— Stefano McGhee, International President-Elect, Toastmasters International

YOUR VOICE BELONGS ON STAGE**Ready to practice for real?**

The fastest way to build speaking confidence is to do it, surrounded by people cheering you on. Find a Toastmasters club near you across Arizona, New Mexico, and West Texas.

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